

Expectations and Guidelines for LST Workers

A guiding principle at LST is that the WORD is the teacher, and WE are the illustration. To help ensure that the WORD is illustrated in our behavior, we ask all LST Workers to abide by the following guidelines. These principles come from years of experience, and they provide guidance for serving in a variety of contexts.

Nurture your faith.

- *The best work of faith flows from a faith that is already at work in you. Jesus reminds us, "But the seed on good soil stands for those with a noble and good heart, who hear the word, retain it, and by persevering produce a crop." (Luke 8)*
- Examples of this principle at work:
 - Reliance on God through prayer.
 - Personal and team devotionals.
 - Engagement with the local/hosting church.

Focus on "we," before considering "me."

- *You are part of a one-another community, and your actions can build that community up. Jesus instructs us, "Do to others what you would have them do to you." (Luke 6)*
- Examples of this principle at work:
 - Surrender a personal preference or comfort because it helps the work.
 - Praise, compliment, and affirm one another (Don't criticize, complain, or debate).
 - Abstain from alcohol and other questionable substances as appropriate for your culture and context.

Pursue a healthy relationship with your Reader.

- *Friendship often comes before faith. Jesus's example encourages us, "When the Lord saw her, his heart overflowed with compassion." (Luke 7)*
- Examples of this principle at work:
 - Be fully present when meeting with your Reader.
 - No romantic relationships with Readers.
 - Refrain from engaging your Reader financially.
 - Be sensitive to issues of privacy (sharing personal information with a Reader, sharing information about or images of your Reader).

Listen to the wisdom of those leading your work.

- *Whether online, in your home city, or serving abroad, listen to the wisdom of the special leaders among you. Jesus urges us, "...take care how you listen." (Luke 8)*
- Examples of this principle at work:
 - Follow the guidance of LST staff and LST training.
 - Involve local leaders in any significant steps of faith your Reader wants to take.
 - Follow the instruction of your Host in areas of cultural appropriateness, work schedule, and activities with Readers.